

development over mere academic performance. Society evolved to assess students not just by their grades but by how well they performed in the professional world. Today, the approach to education is more holistic, blending knowledge, skills, and competencies with a hands-on, kinaesthetic learning experience that prepares students for real-world challenges.

## **In terms of methodology and pedagogy, what are your thoughts on the evolution of teaching styles over the past four decades?**

Our focus at Presidency University is heavily inclined towards critical thinking and experiential learning. We have moved to a more interactive, AI and technology-driven hybrid, blended and application-based learning experience. This shift is evident across all our Academic Programs. Learning has evolved from being teacher-centric to student-centred, with an emphasis on skill development. Techniques like critical and analytical thinking, design thinking, and mind mapping have become integral to modern teaching. The integration of new technologies has

further transformed education, making it more information-driven and dynamic for our tech savvy students.

## **How important do you believe the combination of value-based education and core competencies is in shaping the youth?**

Core values and formal education are deeply interconnected. Education today should be a blend of global perspectives and local relevance, ensuring that students are equipped with both the necessary formal knowledge and the skills required in contemporary industries. However, knowledge alone is not enough. A truly educated individual must also possess strong human values. Values shape character, which, when combined with knowledge and skills, lays the foundation for success in both professional and personal life. This philosophy forms the core of the Presidency ethos, guiding our institutions in shaping well-rounded, thoughtful and civic conscious citizens.

## **Do you feel that the mission you set out to achieve has been fulfilled, and what new benchmarks have you established for PGI?**

Today, Presidency is a reputed education brand and we have always set high standards for ourselves.

As the poet John Keats once said, "... but I have promises to keep, and miles to go before I sleep." This sentiment resonates with me. The journey of building and growing PGI is far from over. I am reminded of the words of the Tamil poetess, Avvaiyar, who said, "What I have learned is but a fistful of sand, and what I don't know is an ocean before me." While we have overcome numerous challenges to reach where we are today, we continue to grow. The mission is an ongoing one, and our path of growth remains endless.

## **The responsibility of taking forward a formidable PGI legacy can be overwhelming. Was taking on the reins of PGI a conscious choice?**

Taking on the leadership of PGI was indeed a natural progression for me. Growing up under my father's mentorship, I witnessed first-hand the incredible journey he undertook—transforming a modest two-room house into a renowned and one of the largest Educational Group. His passion for education and relentless pursuit of excellence are constants that have inspired me. While I acknowledge the weight of the responsibility and the enormity of the legacy, I firmly believe that with the foundation he laid and the lessons I've learned by working alongside him, I'm equipped to carry it forward. The journey isn't just about honoring the past, but also about envisioning the future. As Vice Chairman, I'm excited to lead with the same spirit of innovation and commitment that defined my father's legacy.

## **Could you briefly share how your family and education shaped you for the role of Vice Chairman of PGI?**

My journey has been deeply influenced by both my family and education. Education was always the cornerstone of our household. My parents ensured that I had a strong academic foundation and a sense of discipline. They played an instrumental role in my upbringing. Their unwavering support and insistence on excellence shaped my values and prepared me for this leadership role. Additionally, the experiences and knowledge I gained through my formal education have been invaluable in understanding both the academic and operational aspects of PGI. My wife has equally been a great source of strength and inspiration.

## **What have you brought to the table of PGI that emanates from your experiences in the educational domain?**

While PGI had already established strong operational systems, I believe the education landscape has changed, and with it, the approach to management. One of the key contributions I've made is embracing

## **Leadership Transition: A Vision for the Future**

**The leadership of PGI has successfully transitioned to the next generation.**

**Mr. Suhael Ahmed, Vice Chairman of PGI, reflecting on the high standards set by the Founder and to continue to enhance it. Under his guidance, PGI has adopted modern management practices and introduced innovative strategies to ensure that PGI remains an agile and forward-thinking institution.**



**■ Suhael Ahmed**  
Vice Chairman  
Presidency Group Of Institutions

**Dr. Nafeesa Ahmed, Director of Presidency Schools, has further elevated the quality of education at PGI by focusing on innovation, inclusivity, and excellence. Her exemplary academic credentials include Master's in International Management from Royal Holloway, University of London and also whetted her skills in management and leadership at the famed Harvard School. With a global outlook, she has fostered an environment that nurtures critical thinking, leadership, and emotional intelligence. Dr. Nafeesa has been particularly focused on empowering women and creating opportunities for young leaders to emerge in the education sector.**



**■ Dr. Nafeesa Ahmed**  
Director  
Presidency Group of Institutions